

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Returns & Refunds Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

Document ID	AW-SRV-003
Version	3.2
Last Updated	August 2026
Department	Retail Operations
Company	Aether Wireless
Classification	Internal — Training & Reference

Overview

This policy outlines Aether Wireless's returns and refunds procedures for devices, accessories, and services. It applies to purchases made through Aether Wireless retail locations, online at aetherwireless.com, and by phone. The policy ensures fair treatment of customers while maintaining operational efficiency and preventing fraud.

Return Windows

Returns must be initiated within the specified timeframes from the original purchase date. The return window is determined by the product type and condition at purchase.

Product Type	Return Window	Restocking Fee	Special Conditions
New Device	14 days	\$35	Fee waived for DOA devices
eSIM-Only Service	14 days	\$0	No physical device
Open-Box/Refurbished Device	7 days	\$35	Visible wear acceptable
Accessory (Unopened)	30 days	\$0	Original packaging required
Accessory (Opened)	14 days	\$0	Functional testing required

Refund Mechanics

Processing Timeline

- Refunds are processed within 7-10 business days from the date the returned item is received and inspected
- Refunds are issued to the original payment method
- Credit card refunds may take an additional 3-5 business days to appear on statements

Activation Fee Refunds

- Activation fees are fully refunded when canceling the entire line within the return window
- Partial line cancellations (keeping some services) do not qualify for activation fee refunds

- Used service days are deducted from any refund amount at the daily rate

Device Installments

- Devices purchased on installment plans are refunded the full remaining balance
- Any payments made are refunded to the original payment method
- Installment agreements are canceled upon refund approval

Promotional Credits

- Promotional credits, rebates, and bill credits are clawed back (recovered) upon return
- Customers remain responsible for any promotional requirements not met
- Future promotional eligibility may be affected by returns

Device Condition Requirements

Devices must meet the following condition standards to qualify for returns:

Acceptable Condition

- Original packaging and all included accessories present
- No cracks or damage to screen, body, or components
- Liquid damage indicators (LDI) must not be triggered
- Activation lock (Find My iPhone, Android Device Protection) must be removed
- Factory reset performed with all personal data removed
- Device powers on and functions normally

Prohibited Conditions

- Cracked screens or damaged displays
- Liquid damage or water exposure
- Missing essential accessories (charger, cable, etc.)
- Devices with active activation locks
- Third-party repairs or modifications
- Devices reported lost or stolen

Condition Assessment & Fees

The refund amount is determined by the device's condition upon return inspection:

Condition	Refund Percentage	Additional Fees	Notes
Like New	100%	\$0	No visible wear, all accessories present
Cosmetic Wear	100%	\$35	Minor scratches, scuffs, or wear
Screen Crack	50%	\$35	Visible crack or damage to display

Condition	Refund Percentage	Additional Fees	Notes
Liquid Damage	0%	\$0	No refund, device recycled
Missing Accessories	100% minus value	\$35	Accessory value deducted from refund

Accessory values for deduction:

- Original charger: \$25
- Original cable: \$15
- Original earbuds/headphones: \$30
- Original documentation: \$5
- Original box: \$10

Dead on Arrival (DOA) Handling

Devices that fail to power on or function properly upon first use qualify as DOA:

DOA Criteria

- Device does not power on with a charged battery
- Critical functions fail immediately (calls, data, basic operations)
- Defect is reported within 14 days of purchase
- Device has not been physically damaged

DOA Process

- Replacement shipped next business day at no charge
- Free return shipping label provided for defective device
- Customer may choose refund instead of replacement
- No restocking fee applied to DOA returns
- Replacement device carries full 14-day return window

Online & Mail Returns

Returns initiated through online or mail channels follow additional procedures:

Change of Mind Returns

- \$10 fee deducted from refund for change of mind (not DOA/defective)
- Return shipping label provided for defective items only
- Customer responsible for return shipping costs on change of mind returns

Mail-In Requirements

- Return must be postmarked within the specified return window
- Include original packaging and all accessories
- Include copy of purchase receipt or order confirmation

- Insure package for full value (recommended)
- Tracking number required for proof of mailing

Online Purchase Returns

- Returns can be initiated through account portal or customer service
- Return authorization number required for all mail-in returns
- Refund issued to original payment method only
- Store credit not available for online purchases

Non-Returnable Items

The following items cannot be returned under any circumstances:

- Gift cards and prepaid airtime cards
- Activated digital content (apps, music, media)
- Devices reported lost or stolen
- Devices with active third-party financing
- Third-party repaired or modified devices
- Custom-ordered or personalized devices
- Promotional items marked as "final sale"
- Devices with tampered or removed serial numbers
- Accessories damaged by misuse or abnormal wear

FAQs

Q: Can I return a device if I already transferred my phone number to Aether Wireless?

A: Yes, you can still return the device within the return window. The activation fee will be refunded if you cancel the entire line. Service days used will be deducted from your refund amount.

Q: What happens if I return a device with a cracked screen?

A: Devices returned with screen damage receive a 50% refund plus a \$35 restocking fee. For example, a \$600 device would receive a \$265 refund (\$300 minus \$35 fee).

Q: How do I remove an activation lock before returning my device?

A: For iPhone, go to Settings > [Your Name] > Find My > Turn Off Find My iPhone. For Android, go to Settings > Security > Device Admin Apps > Remove as admin, then go to Settings > Accounts > Google > Remove account. Factory reset the device after removing the lock.

Q: Can I exchange a device instead of getting a refund?

A: Yes, exchanges are allowed within the return window for devices of equal or greater value. The same condition assessment and fees apply. You may exchange for a different model, color, or storage capacity.

Q: What if I lose the original box and some accessories?

A: You can still return the device, but the value of missing accessories will be deducted from your refund. Missing accessories include: charger (\$25), cable (\$15), earbuds (\$30), documentation (\$5), and box (\$10).

Q: Do I need to keep the original receipt to make a return?

A: No, but having your order confirmation number or the email receipt expedites the process. We can look up your purchase using your phone number, email address, or account information.

Questions about returns or refunds? Contact Aether Wireless Customer Care at 1-800-AETHER-1 (1-800-243-4371) or visit aetherwireless.com/support. Retail locations are available for in-person assistance during business hours.